

GLOSSARY

Allies

People or countries working together. In World War I and World War II, the Allies were the countries fighting Germany and other forces.

Ammunition

Objects fired or propelled from a weapon, such as bullets.

Amulet

A small object believed to ward off evil spirits, illness, or danger.

Anglo-Saxon

The people who lived in England from the 5th century and ruled large parts of it until the Norman conquest in 1066.

Ancestor

A person who lived in the past, and who is a distant relative of people who are alive today.

Aqueduct

A special channel (either raised up or buried underground) that carries water.

Archaeologist

A person who excavates sites to reveal their history by studying the objects and human remains found there.

Artillery

Large guns used in warfare.

Artifact

An object made by someone, such as a beautiful vase or a useful pot or tool.

Artisan

A skilled craftsperson producing things by hand.

Autopsy

Examination of a dead body performed by a trained pathologist to find out how the person might have died.

Bacteria

Tiny microscopic life forms that live all around us; some can cause disease and infections.

BCE

A term meaning “Before the Common Era,” placed after a date to indicate it happened before year 0, which is the start of the “Common Era,” or CE.

Bullion

A bar of precious metal, such as silver or gold.

Calligraphy

Handwriting as a highly valued art form, especially in Arabic, Chinese, and Japanese script.

Caravan

A train of animals, usually camels, used to transport goods across long distances. Camel caravans were often used on the Silk Roads.

Cast

A copy of an original artifact, made by pouring plaster into a mold. In archaeology, plaster is poured into holes formed in the earth when bodies and artifacts buried there have decayed.

CE

Abbreviation for “Common Era,” used in dates (see BCE).

Citizen

A person who belongs to a city or a bigger community, such a state or country, and has certain rights.

City-state

A city, and its surrounding territory, that has its own independent government.

Civil war

A war fought between inhabitants of the same country.

Colony

An area under the political and economic control of another state, usually in a foreign country.

Culture

The customs, beliefs, and behavior shared by a society.

Deity

A god or a goddess.

Diplomat

A person appointed by a country or other political body to carry out negotiations and maintain relationships with other countries.

Dogfight

A close battle between two fighter planes, especially in World War I and II.

Dynasty

A family ruling a country for successive generations.

Emperor/Empress

The absolute ruler of an empire.

Empire

A group of lands or peoples under the rule of a single government or person.

Excavate

In archaeology, to dig up an area in an organized way in order to find remains of buildings, people, and artifacts.

Excavation

An area being dug up for archaeological purposes.

Extinct

Describes a species that has no living members.

Fortress

See Fortification

Fortification

A strong building or set of buildings designed to withstand attacks and protect the people inside.

Forensic

Describes work carried out by scientists to help solve crimes.

Fresco

Art painted directly on a wet plaster wall.

Frieze

A decorative carving running along the upper part of the wall of a building.

Galleon

A type of three-masted ship used in the 15th–17th centuries.

Glacier

A large, slow-moving mass of ice on land, often through a mountain valley.

Government

A group of people governing a country, often (but not always) elected to do so.

Gothic

A style of architecture popular in medieval Europe from the 12th century, featuring soaring spires and pointy arches. Also refers to the religious art of that period.

HQ (Headquarters)

In World War I, the place where military commanders stayed, planned, and oversaw the operations on the battlefield.

Immigrant

A person leaving one nation to move to another country and settle there.

Import

The purchase of goods and services from other countries.